

Michael Colenso

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Dynamic Construction Project Manager combining technical expertise with leadership, communication, and client-focused collaboration with a track record of delivering complex projects to demanding owners ahead of schedule and under budget.

Education

Northern Michigan University
BACHELOR OF SCIENCE, CONSTRUCTION MANAGEMENT

2004
Marquette, MI

Professional Experience

Project Manager
STS CONSTRUCTION

2022 – 2024
Seattle, WA

- Led on-site construction team to successfully complete a 58 unit, 8 story, podium style multifamily project in Seattle
- Developed and enforced safety protocols, achieving zero incidents throughout all project phases
- Consistently and effectively implemented a solutions-oriented approach to challenges, reducing conflict by acknowledging all perspectives and highlighting common interests.

Multifamily ConstructionTeam LeadershipBudget Management

Project Manager
TOTH CONSTRUCTION

2020 – 2022
Seattle, WA

- Managed high-end residential construction projects, ensuring impeccable coordination with subcontractors and vendors to deliver luxury built environments with grace and integrity.
- Cultivated strong relationships with ultra-high-net-worth clients and world-class design professionals, as well as extraordinarily talented artisans and craftspeople.

Client RelationsLuxury ResidentialProject Scheduling

Project Manager
OSBORNE CONSTRUCTION COMPANY

2018 – 2019
Redmond, WA

- Provided stakeholders with detailed monthly cost reports and cash flow projections, enhancing financial decision-making
- Managed multiple and ongoing scope changes and successfully prepared,negotiated, and executed all owner change orders and subcontract modifications as required
- Created and managed a comprehensive CPM project schedule that was crucial to the successful delivery of the project.

Risk ManagementFinancial ReportingStakeholder CommunicationChange Management

Project Manager
DISCOVERY LAND COMPANY

2017 – 2018
Abaco, Bahamas

- Oversaw construction of multiple luxury homes in a private development for extremely discerning clients expecting the highest level of service as well as the utmost discretion
- Managed all project phases across international borders, efficiently resolving logistical challenges related to timely procurement of construction materials
- Established strong vendor partnerships, ensuring material availability despite supply chain constraints on a remote and rural island location

International ProjectsLuxury ResidentialProcurement

Project Manager
SODO BUILDERS

2016 – 2017
Seattle, WA

- Implemented and tracked changes to the scope of work while mitigating claims risk; Provided value-engineered solutions where applicable and negotiated subcontractor change orders when required.
- Coordinated high-rise building envelope construction including curtain wall system, precast elements, and insulated metal panels for both towers.

High-Rise ConstructionValue EngineeringClaims Mitigation

Software Developer / Senior Software Engineer
ADONIT, TEAM COCO, CLOUDMUNCH

2012 – 2015
Los Angeles, CA & Seattle, WA

- Self-taught programming skills leading to significant contributions in professional software teams
- Advanced to Senior Software Engineer at a cloud services startup, driving product development and scaling solutions

Software DevelopmentCross-Functional Collaboration

Project Engineer
GRAHAM CONSTRUCTION

2007 – 2011
Seattle, WA

- Managed over \$50 million in contracted scope, completing two projects in 18 months for a single owner
- Supported preconstruction efforts on negotiated and design-build projects, coordinating bids for public and private clients
- Executed complex projects in education, retail, hospitality, and seismic retrofit sectors

PreconstructionProject ManagementMultisector Experience

Project Engineer
SKENDER CONSTRUCTION

2006 – 2007
Chicago, IL

- Evaluated and reviewed bids to ensure alignment with project requirements and budget goals
- Developed scopes of work and negotiated subcontracts for a senior care facility project
- Monitored project progress, ensuring adherence to key milestones and objectives

Bid EvaluationContract NegotiationHealthcare Facilities

Field Engineer
WEST BUILDERS

2004 – 2006
Los Angeles, CA

- Controlled project costs and monitored progress, ensuring adherence to schedules and budgets
- Managed procurement, change analysis, and document control on a complex, high-stakes project

Cost ControlProcurementProject DocumentationMultifamily

Selected Projects

2210 Eastlake
8-STORY, 57-UNIT APARTMENT BUILDING

\$12M

Seattle, WA

- 35,000 SF, 8-story, 57-unit multifamily apartment building in Seattle’s Eastlake neighborhood (podium construction: 6 over 2).
- Held full responsibility for project team development and direction, client relations, subcontractor coordination, project scheduling and controls, and project financials—including reporting and forecasting.

Multifamily

Project Management

Team Leadership

255 S. King St
TWIN TOWERS DEVELOPMENT IN PIONEER SQUARE

\$200M

Seattle, WA

- Managed the construction of a 600,000 SF development in Seattle’s Pioneer Square, including two concrete towers: a 23-story Embassy Suites hotel and an 18-story office tower/parking garage connected by a 10-story glass atrium.
- Coordinated complex logistics and sequencing for high-rise construction, ensuring adherence to aggressive timelines and budget constraints.

High-Rise Construction

Hospitality

Hyatt Place Hotel & Apartments
HOTEL AND APARTMENTS COMPLETED TWO MONTHS EARLY

\$40M

Seattle, WA

- Spearheaded mid-project implementation of the Last Planner System, creating aggressive and efficient construction schedules; achieved substantial completion two months early.
- Implemented 25 Construction Change Directives in the final four months, successfully negotiating over \$4M in late changes to project scope while maintaining project momentum.
- Fostered a culture of trust and collaboration with the owner/client by consistently demonstrating advocacy, fairness, diligence, and transparency throughout a challenging project.

Hospitality

Multi-Family

Last Planner System

Change Management

The Alaska Building Renovation
AWARD-WINNING HISTORIC RENOVATION

\$12M+

Seattle, WA

- Executed over \$6M in negotiated changes while maintaining a positive and cooperative relationship with the owner.
- Developed marketing content, including copy and photography, contributing to the project’s recognition with prestigious national awards.
- 2009 National Excellence in Construction Awards - Eagle Award Winner for Best Historic Restoration
- 2009 Northwest Construction - Best Historic Renovation

Historic Restoration

Seismic Retrofit

Award-Winning Projects

Barton Senior Residences
SENIOR RESIDENCE PROJECT COMPLETED 15% FASTER

\$12M

Chicago, IL

- Led a project-specific Lean Construction initiative, collaborating closely with key trades to develop an aggressive and achievable project schedule using the Last Planner System.
- Achieved nearly 10% budget savings through diligent and timely buyout negotiations and contract execution.

Healthcare Facilities

Lean Construction

Scheduling

Temple Lofts
HISTORIC TEMPLE CONVERTED INTO LUXURY LOFTS

\$25M

Los Angeles, CA

- Managed the seismic retrofit and complete renovation of a historic Masonic Temple in downtown Long Beach, converting it into luxury loft apartments.
- Preserved historical elements while integrating modern amenities, resulting in high tenant satisfaction and occupancy rates.
- Navigated complex regulatory requirements for historic buildings, securing necessary approvals without project delays.

Historic Renovation

Seismic Retrofit

Multi-Family Housing

Quail Park of Lynnwood Expansion
EXPANSION OF SENIOR LIVING FACILITY

\$35M

Seattle, WA

- Managed a large 3-story addition to an existing and fully operational assisted living/memory care facility, ensuring minimal disruption to residents.
- Added 14 independent cottage-style duplex residences, along with associated sitework and utility scope.
- Coordinated closely with facility management to maintain safety and operational efficiency throughout construction.

Senior Living

Facility Expansion

Project Coordination

Luxury Residential Projects
MULTIPLE PROJECTS

\$15M

Seattle & Bahamas

- Managed major remodels of historic homes in Seattle, including projects in The Highlands and Laurelhurst neighborhoods.
- Coordinated construction of a custom apartment home on the 57th floor of a new Seattle high-rise. The client combined three units to create a unique and expansive space. Successfully integrated custom luxury residential design elements and materials into the building’s mechanical and structural systems, presenting a notable yet satisfying challenge.
- Built several high-end beach vacation homes at Bakers Bay, an exclusive private development in the Bahamas. Interesting logistical challenges related to this international, rural island location included material procurement, workforce availability, and schedule management.

Luxury Residential

International

Project Management